

WAY TO THE TOP

Knowledge is power. It will help in everything you set out to do. Building up a large base of knowledge will keep you ahead of the competition. Who knows? You may even end up running the country or winning a Nobel Prize. You're already on the way; as American physician Benjamin Spock (1903-1998) said, "You know more than you think you do."

FUN FACTOR

Natural curiosity makes us want to find out about the world around us and how it works. Learning more information means you can take part in quizzes and win prizes for your general knowledge. You can also impress your friends with different skills, such as soccer. You couldn't score a goal without first knowing how to kick a ball.

CAN YOU DISCOVER KNOWLEDGE?

Knowledge is not just something you get from reading books or listening to teachers. The discoveries you make for yourself are even more important, and you make them all the time without always recognizing it. Here are three ways you find things out for yourself, but there are many other ways, too.

OBSERVATION

One of the most important ways we learn is by watching other people do things and then imitating them. When you see other people sit down on chairs, you understand their purpose and learn to sit on a chair for yourself. This is the power of observation.

MAKING MISTAKES

You discover that some actions lead to unpleasant consequences and remember to avoid them. This is also called learning from experience. That person has learned the hard way to check whether his chair is safe to sit on. In the future, he won't make the same mistake again.

TRIAL AND ERROR

This is a way of gathering information by testing various ideas and seeing which one will work the best. For example, to make a paper airplane, you construct several prototypes (trial models) and test-fly them until you come up with the perfect design.